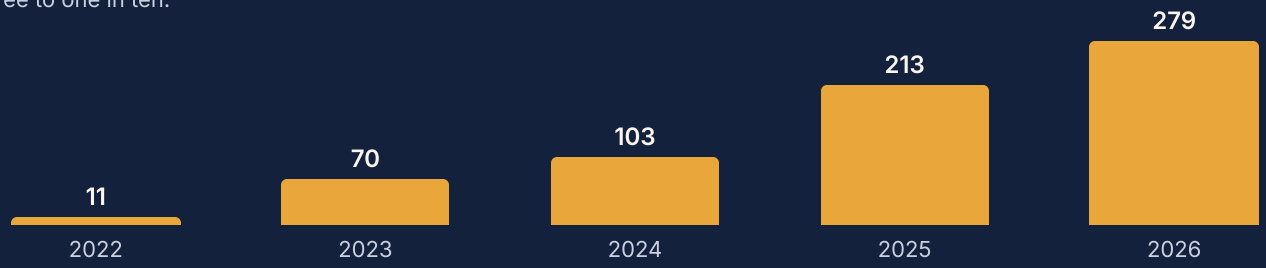
FOR HOSTS AND CREATORS WHO RECEIVE PITCHES

How to handle pitches without burning out

One independent host's two mailboxes, 2022 to October 2026: 676 pitch-like threads from 489 senders. Volume tripled, and his explicit declines grew from 7% of pitches in 2023 to 55% in 2026.

Pitch threads per year, both mailboxes

Explicit declines were 7% of pitch threads in 2023, 13% in 2024, 28% in 2025 and 55% in 2026. Silence fell from about one in three to one in ten.



1 Write the rule before the volume

This host asked for a pivotal moment from 2022 and was declining pitches that did not fit by 2023. A written rule makes the no easy to send.

2 Keep three replies ready

Not the right fit. Fully booked. Tell me the specific moment. Each is a few lines long.

3 Say your rule where pitchers read it

A pitch page that names the one moment, the current focus and what the show is not should screen pitches before they arrive.

4 Ask once

If a pitch hints at a story, one clear question about the moment is enough. Do not workshop an angle with a sender who sent a topic list.

5 Judge the story, not the sender

Publicists and experts send a large share of pitches. The same test applies to them as to anyone.

6 Say what silence means

About one pitch thread in three got no reply through 2025. If you will not answer every pitch, tell senders so.

7 Tag every pitch by outcome

Advanced, asked, declined, silent. Labeled mail is how this host could see his own drift, and steer it on purpose.

8 Plan for being one person

The host runs the show alone. A short template keeps a late no kind, and a written rule keeps it quick.

2022, AN OPEN INVITATION

"I'd love to talk more about one of the most pivotal moments in your life, if you'd like to share."

2026, A CLEAR RULE

"The show is built around one deeply personal moment where everything changed for the guest."

Real, anonymized mail, analyzed with Claude. Counts are approximate. 2022 is partial, 2026 runs to October.